

COCAMIDOPROPYL BETAINE

_____Name

_____Date

also called... cocoyl amide propyldimethyl glycine, coconut oil amidopropyl betaine, disodium cocoamphodipropionate, CAPB, or Tegobetaine. Amidoamine or dimethylaminopropylamine, impurities from its production, may be the actual sensitizer. Cross-sensitivity may occur to the related chemicals **cocamide MEA** and **cocobetaine**. You may also need to avoid related **cocamidopropylamine oxide** and **oleamidopropyl dimethylamine**. [CAPB usually does NOT show cross-sensitization to cocamide diethanolamide, also known as cocamide DEA.]

What is it?

Cocamidopropyl betaine (CAPB) is a mild sudsing agent derived from coconut. It is a component of most shampoos, bath gels, bar soaps, and liquid soaps. It may be used for thickening, foam stabilizing, or anti-static.

Where might it be found?

liquid hand soap
bar soap, body wash
hand cleanser
shower or bath gel
baby wash
bubble bath
skin cleanser
facial cleanser
makeup remover
shave gel
acne wash
acne treatment, scrub
exfoliating wash
moistened washcloths
cleansing pads
anal hygiene product
gynecologic product
shampoo
hair conditioner
hair mousse, gel, foam
hair color
hair bleach
contact lens cleaner
toothpaste
mouthwash
antiseptic
liquid detergents
household cleaners
surface cleaners
pet shampoo

Dermatitis from shampoo may affect the scalp, face, neck, eyes, ears, or hands. Body washes or soaps containing CAPB can lead to a widespread rash. Local cleansers may cause face, eyelid, genital, or perianal dermatitis. Contact lens cleaners with CAPB may cause eyelid rash or conjunctivitis.

How to avoid it:

Avoid using any product that contains **cocamidopropyl betaine**. Read the complete ingredient list on the label of everything you use, looking for CAPB or one of the other names listed above. If no ingredient list is present, go to the store and inspect the original box or package. Some products' ingredient lists are available on the internet at the manufacturer's website, the store's website, or at websites such as <http://householdproducts.nlm.nih.gov>, <http://www.cosmeticsdatabase.com>, or <http://www.drugstore.com>.

Ask your hairdresser, barber, or attendant to avoid using products that contain cocamidopropyl betaine in your care.

For possible workplace exposure, check the complete ingredient list of each product you encounter. If you must come in contact with this agent at work or in care of children, elders, or pets, wear protective rubber, or vinyl gloves.

If you are unable to find substitute products that are free of this allergen, ask your dermatologist.